SUBSTITUTE PLAN · WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2026

3rd Period: Studio Express

6th grade exploration class · 50 minutes · Chromebooks

You do NOT need to teach this. Everything students need is on the website, and it walks them through every step. Your job today is classroom management: keep them on task, keep it kind, and fill in the roster.

WRITE THIS ON THE BOARD
doubleblaze.solutions/express

FINISHED GAMES (FOR GRADING)
doubleblaze.solutions/express/today

The 50 minutes

0 to 5 min	Take attendance. Read the 3 things below out loud. Students open the link on the board.
5 to 30 min	**Design.** Students answer the questions on screen, one step at a time.
30 to 40 min	**Build and play.** They press Build, wait 10 to 20 seconds while a fun build screen runs, then play their own game.
40 to 47 min	**Play classmates' games** from the finished-games page. Early finishers can press Remix to improve their game.
47 to 50 min	**Show the sub.** Each student shows you their game playing. Check them off. Chromebooks away.

Read this out loud at the start:

1. "Today you are a game studio. You will design your own video game, watch it get built, and play it. Go to **doubleblaze.solutions/express**."
2. "Use your **initials and a studio name**, never your real name. Keep every name school appropriate."
3. "If you are stuck, read the **orange box** on your screen. It tells you exactly what is missing. Before the bell, show me your game playing. That is your grade."

Grading: two grades, equal points

1. Completion: 50 points. Their game is on the finished-games page with their initials, and they showed you it playing. Designed but did not finish building: 25.

2. Behavior: 50 points, your call. Use the rubric and roster on page 3. A quick mark per student is plenty.

WHAT IS HAPPENING ON THEIR SCREENS

What students are doing

Each student works **on their own**. They design a video game using what they have learned this semester (purpose, users, user stories, checks, and scenarios), then watch it get built and play it. The site asks them, step by step:

1. **Who they are:** period, initials, and a studio name.
2. **Their game:** a name, a genre (Platformer, Top-down quest, or Sky dodge), and the feeling it should give a player.
3. **Their hero and world:** who you play and where it happens.
4. **What the hero collects, and what is in the way.**
5. **A core loop:** 3 verbs the player does over and over (like run, jump, collect).
6. **Mechanics:** a power-up, plus numbers for speed, jump and lives.
7. **A player story:** "As a player, I want to ___ so I can ___", one check (how we would know it works), and a bad day (Given / When / Then).

Then they press **Build**. Spark, the site's AI helper, designs their game in about 10 to 20 seconds while a build screen keeps them busy. Then they play it.

> **If a student asks "what do I do?"** Say: "Follow the steps on the screen. The orange box tells you what is missing."

Classroom management

- **Chromebooks stay on this site.** Other tabs and games are a behavior reminder.
- **Sound stays off.** The games are silent unless a student turns sound on. Ask them to keep it off.
- **Initials only, no real names**, and school-appropriate names. The site blocks bad words, but please redirect anyone trying.
- **Help each other, but do not type on someone else's Chromebook.** Everyone builds their own game.

If something goes wrong

The site will not load, or the wifi is down	Hand out the paper design worksheet (last page, copy as needed). A complete worksheet counts for completion. Collect them and leave them for me.
A build takes over a minute	It falls back to a simpler builder on its own. Ask them to wait, or press Build again.
A student finishes in 10 minutes	Press Remix to improve their game (up to 3 builds), then play and review classmates' games on the finished-games page.
A student is stuck on a box	The orange box on screen says exactly what is missing. Point them to it.
A student says their game is broken	That is great feedback. Have them write down what they did and what happened, and leave it for me.

Thank you for covering today. The students have been working hard on this all semester and they love seeing their ideas come to life.

ROSTER · 3RD PERIOD · WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 4

Completion and behavior

Completion /50: 50 = game on the finished-games page and shown to you playing. 25 = designed but did not finish building (or a complete paper worksheet counts as 50 if the site was down). 0 = did not start.

Behavior /50: 50 = on task, respectful, Chromebook used appropriately. 40 = needed 1 reminder. 25 = several reminders. 10 = refused to work or was disruptive.

	Student name	Initials on site	Completion /50	Behavior /50	Notes
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
7					
8					
9					
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11					
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29					
30					

FOR THE TEACHER

Note from the sub

A few lines is plenty. Leave this on the desk with the roster and any worksheets.

How did it go overall?

Students who were especially helpful or on task

Students who needed reminders, and what for

Anything that did not work on the site (what they did, what happened)

Anything else

Substitute name: _____ Did the site work? ☐ Yes ☐ Mostly ☐ No, we used paper

BACKUP WORKSHEET · ONLY IF THE SITE IS DOWN

Studio Express: design your game

Period _____ **Initials** (not your name) _____ **Studio name** _____

1. Game name

_____

2. Genre (circle one): Platformer · Top-down quest · Sky dodge

3. The feeling: how should a player feel? (brave, fast, clever, sneaky, epic, chill, spooky...)

_____

4. Hero's name (and what they look like)

_____

5. World: where does it happen?

_____

6. What the hero collects

_____

7. What is in the way

_____

8. Core loop: 3 verbs the player does over and over _____ → _____ → _____ → again

9. Mechanics. Power-up (circle one): Shield · Speed boost · Magnet · Double jump · Slow time

Speed (1 to 10): ____ Jump (1 to 10): ____ Lives (1 to 5): ____

10. Player story: As a player, I want to

_____

so I can

_____

11. One check: how would we know it works? (a yes or no test)

_____

12. A bad day: something goes wrong. What should the game do?

Given

_____

When

_____

Then

_____

Something special (a twist, a boss, a secret), optional:

_____